

BIJLI — Game Proposal

TGC GameJam (GDAI × Games for Change India × Infinium '26) · Team **Buggernaut** · 2 October 2026

Team

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All three members are students at IIIT Hyderabad. Public repository: github.com/NavyaUpd/buggernaut.

Game overview

BIJLI is a 2D action-platformer set on a monsoon night, about the people who bring the light back. *Bijli* means both electricity and lightning in Hindi. The city's power is out. You play a lineworker climbing poles in the storm, splicing snapped cables and dodging live wires to restore power district by district. At home, a child named Chinni sits by candlelight drawing a comic about the lineworker as a superhero called **BIJLI**. **Wherever you bring the light back, the world turns into Chinni's comic, and the comic helps you through.**

Genre 2D action-platformer where light turns the world into a comic

Platform Browser (HTML5 / WebGL)

Length 7 short levels, under 20 minutes

Gameplay idea

The heart of the game is one simple rule: **fix the light, and the comic opens a path.**

- **In the dark** you are a lineworker in a real, rain-soaked city. You climb poles, find snapped cables and twist them back together, careful of live wires and the storm.
- **In the light**, every area you power up turns into Chinni's comic. Crayon platforms appear, wires become rails to ride, and dangers turn into friendly cartoon versions of themselves.
- **Chinni's drawings** are a power-up: pick one up and you briefly become **BIJLI**, the superhero from her comic.

The game is built to be learned in under a minute, with only a handful of simple controls.

Game flow

One stormy night, seven short levels, moving from a quiet lane to a boss fight and then home. Between levels, a page of Chinni's comic and a short phone message carry the story.

1. **The lane.** The first lamp comes back on, and players discover the light turns the world into a comic.
2. **The bazaar.** Rooftops and tangled wires; the comic starts helping in bigger ways.
3. **The underpass.** A flooded road where the dark is at its most dangerous.
4. **The rooftops.** A climb through wind and lightning, where the storm fights back.
5. **The hospital.** A race to restore power before the backup runs out.
6. **The substation.** A boss fight against the storm's fire dragon.
7. **Home.** No enemies, the rain thins: one last line to a small house with a candle in the window.

Finale. The house lights up and Chinni runs to the window. The lineworker lifts off the helmet: it's **Amma**. The hero has had no pronouns all game, so players discover what they had assumed. Chinni draws the last panel: *"my amma is bijli."*

How the themes are used

All three themes sit inside the core mechanics, not only in the art or story, and each appears in gameplay, world and narrative.

Theme	In the gameplay	In the world	In the story
Light	Bringing the light back is the goal, and light is what changes the level: wherever it reaches, new paths open	A blacked-out city lighting up behind you, lamp by lamp	Neighbours cheer “light aa gayi!”; the last light is home. <i>Bijli</i> means both electricity and lightning
Twist	Repairs mean twisting snapped cables back together, and light twists every danger into a friendly comic version	Every real danger has a comic double	The plot twist: the hero is Amma
Comic	Lit areas become Chinni’s comic, and her drawings turn you into the superhero BIJLI	Ink outlines, halftone dots, crayon colours, sound-effect words	The story is told through Chinni’s comic pages, and the finale is the last page

We also read *comic* as funny: the comic world is loud and silly, which balances the quiet tension of the real one.

Why it matters

BIJLI celebrates everyday heroes doing jobs people say are “not for them”, and lets players feel it rather than read it. It is inspired by the linewomen of Telangana: in 2022, Babburi Sirisha from Siddipet became the first woman appointed junior lineman at the state’s southern power distribution company, after clearing the pole-climbing test (source). Our hero is fictional; an end card credits the inspiration and reminds players never to touch a fallen wire.

All code is written during the jam in our public repository, art is generated in code, audio is procedural, and any outside asset or AI tool use will be declared in the credits. Checkpoints, a skip-level option and a reduce-flashing setting make sure every judge can finish the game.